

The Watch

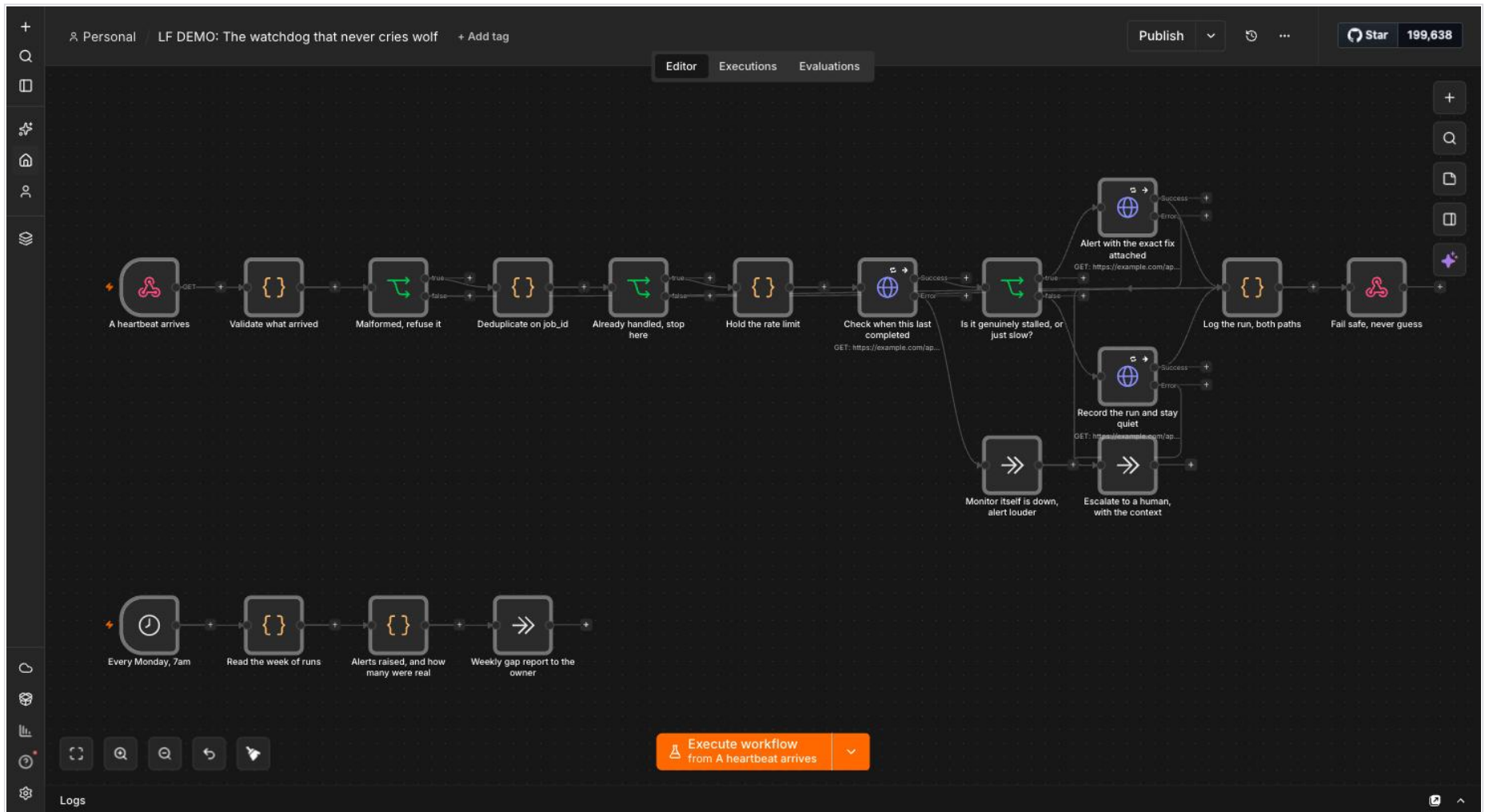
alerting · built in n8n

Something breaks silently and the business hears it from a customer. That's the most expensive way to find out.

What it connects to: The thing that breaks and the thing that tells you are never the same system, and the watchdog must not depend on the system it is watching.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the watchdog, with the exact fix carried inside the alert rather than just the symptom.



2 of 4 THINKING

It's tested against a planted failure before it ever watches anything real — an alert nobody trusts gets muted.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a node titled "Is it genuinely stalled, or just slow?". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters Section: Contains a "Conditions" field with a JSON expression: `{{ $json.stalled === true && $json.minutesSince > $json.threshold }}`. A dropdown menu next to it shows "is true". Below the conditions field is a button "+ Add condition". There is also a toggle switch for "Convert types where required" which is currently turned off. Below that is an "Options" section with a button "+ Add option". An orange button "Execute step" is located at the top right of the Parameters section.

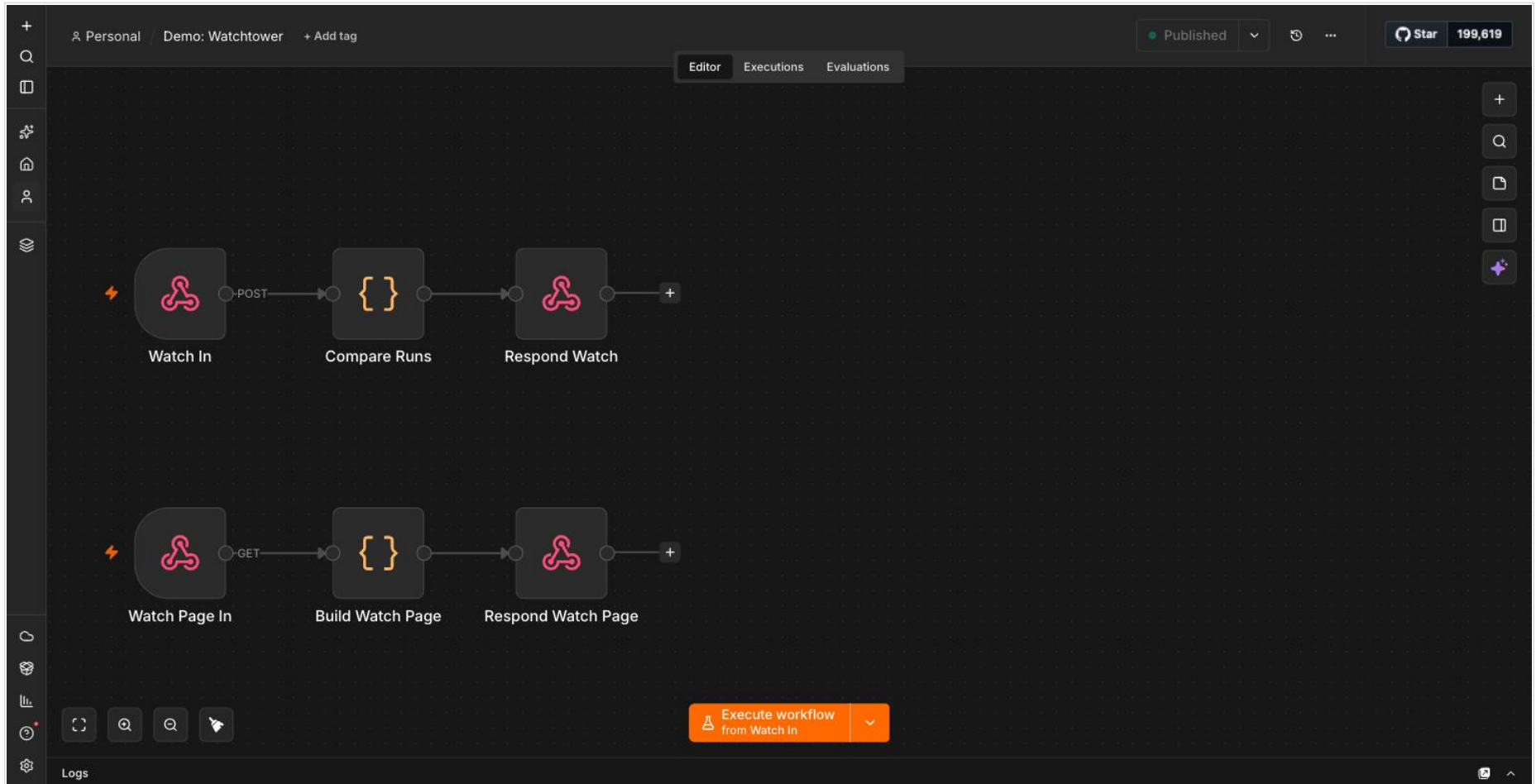
OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "to view output data".

At the bottom of the Parameters section, there is a placeholder text: "I wish this node would...".

The interface also includes a "Docs" link and a close button in the top right corner, and a "Logs" tab at the bottom left.

3 of 4 THEIR-WORLD

The alerting path in the CRM, escalating with context.



4 of 4 MORE

And the precision check: how many alerts were actually real.

The screenshot displays the Node-RED web interface with the 'HTTP Request' node selected. The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, SETTINGS, and OUTPUT.

- INPUT:** Shows 'No input data' with a button 'Execute previous nodes' and the text 'to view input data'.
- SETTINGS:** Contains configuration options for the node:
 - Parameters:** Includes toggle switches for 'SSL Certificates', 'Always Output Data', 'Execute Once', and 'Retry On Fail' (which is currently enabled).
 - Max. Tries:** A numeric input field set to '3'.
 - Wait Between Tries (ms):** A numeric input field set to '2000'.
 - On Error:** A dropdown menu set to 'Continue (using error output)'.
 - Notes:** A text area for adding notes, currently empty.
 - Display Note in Flow?:** A toggle switch, currently disabled.
- OUTPUT:** Shows 'No output data' with a button 'Execute step' and the text 'or set mock data'. It also includes informational text: 'This node will automatically retry if it fails' and 'Execution will continue even if the node fails'.

At the bottom of the interface, there is a 'Logs' tab and a footer message: 'HTTP Request node version 4.2 (Latest version: 4.5)' and a link 'I wish this node would...'.